

Other Non-Driving Penalties for Alcohol-Related Offenses

A person, who purchases, furnishes, or sells an alcoholic beverage to a minor is subject to the penalties listed in the table below.

Table 10: Penalties for Purchasing, Furnishing, or Selling Alcohol to a Minor

Offense	Penalty
Purchased or furnished alcohol to a minor	A fine of up to \$4,000 and/or confinement in jail for up to one year.
Sold alcohol to a minor	A fine of up to \$4,000 and/or confinement in jail for up to one year.

Occupational License (Essential Need License)

An occupational license, also called an essential need license, is a special type of restricted license issued to individuals:

1. Whose driver license has been canceled, suspended, revoked, or denied for certain offenses (other than medical or delinquent child support); and
2. Who can prove to a court there is an essential need to drive.

Application for an occupational license is made to the district, county, or justice of the peace court in the precinct or county of the licensee's residence or to the court of original jurisdiction, whichever is applicable. If the court determines an individual is eligible for an occupational license, then a court order will be issued. The court order authorizes DPS to issue the occupational license. The applicant must submit the court order and all required items to DPS before an occupational license can be issued. The fee for this type of license is \$10 for one year or \$20 if authorized for two years. The court order may be used for 45 days for driving purposes while the occupational license is being processed. After 45 days, you must have both the court order and the occupational license in your possession.

A person issued an occupational license must also carry a certified copy of the court order when operating a vehicle and must allow a law enforcement officer to examine the order at the officer's lawful request. An occupational license may not be issued to drive a commercial motor vehicle.

For more information on occupational licenses, visit our website at <https://www.dps.texas.gov/section/driver-license/occupational-driver-license>.